

**Question:**

Melanie is a door-to-door saleswoman. She sold a third of her vacuum cleaners at the green house, 2 more to the red house, and half of what was left at the orange house. If Melanie has 5 vacuum cleaners left, how many did she start with?

**Reasoning + Answer:**

<think>  
She sold half of what was left to the orange house , so before selling to the orange house she had  $5 * 2 = 10$  . She sold 2 to the red house , so before selling to the red house she had  $10 + 2 = 12$  . She sold a third at the green house , so she started with  $12 * 3 / 2 = 18$  .  
</think>  
< answer >  
18  
</answer>

